CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 16

Auden *Pryor*

TOWN HISTORIAN AND KEEPER OF THE LANTERN GHOST LEGEND

"You know every legend in the Hollow. Tonight you met a new one."



FOR AUDEN PRYOR'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 7+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A tweed jacket or cardigan, a scarf and an old book under your arm. Add a pair of glasses without lenses.

Mask: a brown paper owl mask with big round eyes.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

> **If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.** You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

You have spent ten years writing a history of the candle works. Vesper refused to let you borrow the Hall's archive.

YOUR SECRET

Last spring you borrowed the 1890 candle-works ledger from the library without asking and never put it back. You were afraid the museum appraiser would notice it missing.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:20 to 8:50 you were alone in the library, putting the ledger back on its shelf before anyone noticed. At 8:48 you heard guests shout about the ghost and ran to the ballroom.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the borrowed ledger quiet until Round 2.
- Tell the Lantern Ghost legend to anyone who will listen.
- Find out what the museum plan means for the archive.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Tell everyone the legend: every Halloween since the candle works opened, one lantern drifts along the gallery windows, from the first to the last, then winks out. People say it is the first chandler of the Hall checking every wick. Say you were reading in the library from 8:20 until the shouting at 8:48.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** “Have you ever seen the Lantern Ghost up close?”
- Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** “Will the Gazette print the legend this year?”

YOUR TASK

> Tell the legend to at least two people who haven’t heard it.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Admit you borrowed the 1890 ledger last spring and slipped it back tonight. It lists six brass candle molds, made in 1890, each stamped with a small crescent moon. You can tell a real one from a copy by that moon.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Marlo Quince:** “Do the molds in the display case still have their crescent-moon stamps?”
- Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** “Did Vesper ever let anyone take things out of the Hall?”

YOUR TASK

> Find out who was in the Lantern Gallery between 8:30 and 8:40.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

The real molds would be worth a great deal to a collector, perhaps $1,800 for the six. A copy good enough to fool the town for two years must have been made by someone very handy with molds and wax.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "What did Vesper say about the museum when you two argued?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Could you have made a copy of a brass mold?"

YOUR TASK

> Decide whether the Lantern Ghost is real, and say so out loud.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade